Skills Summary

Teen Numbers — Fixing Swapped Tens and Ones

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Skill 1 — Reading 1 ten and some ones (read-tens-and-ones)

Rule:

A teen number is **1 ten** and some **ones**. Say it and build it in this order: **tens first, ones second**.

1 ten = one full ten-frame = one ten-stick. Then count the loose ones.
Write the tens digit in the **left** box and the ones digit in the **right** box: $\boxed{\text{tens}}\,\boxed{\text{ones}}$

Example: Build the number that is 1 ten and 5 ones.
Step 1. The tens digit tells how many full ten-frames, so it is 1; the ones digit tells how many loose dots, so it is 5.
Step 2. Tens first, ones second: 1 ten is 10, and 10 and 5 more is **15**.

Try it: Build the number that is 1 ten and 2 ones.

check: **12**

Skill 2 — Fixing a swapped number (fix-swapped-digits)

How to check for a swap:

1. Count the **tens** in the picture. **2.** Count the **ones**. **3.** Ask: does the *first* digit match the number of tens?

If the first digit is bigger than the number of full ten-frames, the digits were **swapped**. Put them back: tens digit first.

Example: A child builds 1 ten and 3 ones, then writes a number whose first digit is 3.
Step 1. The first digit should count the *tens*, and there is only 1 ten — so the digits were swapped.
Step 2. Swap them back: 1 ten first, then 3 ones, giving 10 and 3 more, which is **13**.

Try it: A child builds 1 ten and 6 ones but writes the 6 first. Write the correct number.

check: **16**

Skill 3 — Comparing a swapped pair (compare-swapped-pair)

Rule:

The same two digits swapped are **not** the same number. To compare, look at the **tens** digit first — more tens always wins.

$<$ means *is less than.* $>$ means *is greater than.*

Example: Compare the number made from 1 ten and 5 ones with the number made from 5 tens and 1 one.
Step 1. Compare the tens first: the first number has 1 ten, the second has 5 tens.
Step 2. 5 tens is more than 1 ten, so the first number is the smaller one: $<$.

Try it: Compare the number made from 7 tens and 1 one with the number made from 1 ten and 7 ones.

check: $>$

(!) Watch out: Teen numbers are *said* ones-first ("six-teen") but *written* tens-first. Hearing "six" first is why the digits get swapped — build the ten before you write anything.